



RAJASTHAN

Desert Cooler

A some-time actor who is a former minister and businessman, sworn enemies are among the Congress candidates in Rajasthan. Bina Kak, who has acted in a movie as Salman Khan's mother is a former minister who who still has Bollywood dreams while Rajiv Arora is the owner of Amrapali jewellery. The two fell out when Kak, as minister for tourism allegedly eased out Arora who was chairman of the state Tourism Corporation. For the sake of peace and tranquillity in the party, it is hoped that both will win and share the Assembly benches. Or else, both lose.

by Rohit Parihar



BINA KAK

PURUSHOTTAM DIWAKAR



ASSEMBLY
Elections 08

TONGUE TWISTER

Considering what leaders like Raj Thackeray and his mean streetfighters from the MNS are doing in Mumbai to "outsiders", this is something that is truly heartwarming—and may even bring in the votes. The south Indian cell of the BJP, a party which is mostly seen south of the Vindhyas as a north Indian party, is sending out campaigners to speak the voters lingo in areas like R.K. Puram and Mayur Vihar while Akali leaders will tour Sikh-majority areas. Ditto for leaders from Uttarakhand. Now that's called national integration for votes.

by Shafi Rahman



SAURABH SINGH

Rs 150 crore worth of assets were declared by K.S. Tanwar, a BSP candidate in Delhi. He'd now wish it were votes.

ANIMAL FARM

Why has the resounding defeat of the Republicans in United States cast gloom in the BSP? Well, both parties share the elephant as party symbol. But though the majestic animal is faring poorly electorally, there are no takers for the Democrats' symbol—the donkey.

VINAY SHARMA



It's All in the Name

Chhattisgarh Minister Ajay Chandrakar has a winning strategy—confuse the voter. So he has fielded three more candidates with the same name as his Congress opponent Lekhrum Sahu.

Calling in the VOTES

With conservative groups in Mizoram saying door-to-door campaigns encourage use of money power, it's SMSes all the way. Cell phone cos are laughing all the way to the bank.

Partners in Crime

In Delhi, both BJP and Congress have fielded 10 candidates each with a criminal record. BJP's score in Chhattisgarh is four, while Congress's is two.